

Applicant: Nihat Cetinkaya · nihatcetinkaya077@gmail.com · Turkey

Repository: github.com/001453/newtranslate

Demo: youtu.be/1cxwP5S7-1A · **Request:** 7,500 USD₹

GlobalBridge AI — Tether Grant Application

Apply at: <https://tether.dev> → **Apply for a grant**

Category: Applications on Tether's open stack · QVAC integration · Pears / Keet (P2P)

Program: [Tether Developer Grants — local-first AI & payments](#)

Repository: <https://github.com/001453/newtranslate>

License: MIT

Copy-paste for application form

Project title

GlobalBridge AI – Sovereign Live Translation with QVAC + Keet P2P

Short description (≤ 280 characters)

Open-source app: local Whisper STT + QVAC @qvac/sdk translation + Keet P2P meeting captions. Zero audio egress in Sovereign Mode. Live subtitles, dictation, meeting export (.txt/.json/.srt). MIT, self-hostable.

Long description

GlobalBridge AI is a sovereign real-time translation bridge. Speech is transcribed locally (Faster-Whisper), translated and summarized via Tether QVAC (@qvac/sdk sidecar on port 8765), and shown as live captions – without sending audio or transcripts to the cloud when Sovereign Mode is enabled.

We integrate with Keet (Holepunch P2P): users run encrypted calls in Keet while GlobalBridge captures tab audio locally and renders personalized subtitles in each participant's native language (viewer_lang). The same pipeline powers YouTube, Zoom, Meet, and Teams via browser tab capture.

Stack: Python FastAPI, Next.js 15, @qvac/sdk, faster-whisper. Working MVP is open source: <https://github.com/001453/newtranslate>

Grant funds will deliver deeper Pear/Keet integration, VAD-based caption segmentation, a Chrome extension for live captions, benchmark documentation (see docs/BENCHMARKS.md – ~1.9 s live caption p50 on CPU), and a public demo video for the Tether ecosystem.

Grant category (select / describe)

- ☒ New applications powered by Tether's open tech stack
- ☒ Tooling, integrations (QVAC + Pears/Keet)
- ☒ Documentation & developer onboarding

Requested amount

7,500 USD₿ (milestone-based, see below)

Payment preference

USD₿

Links

Resource	URL
Source code	https://github.com/001453/newtranslate
Grant application	https://github.com/001453/newtranslate/blob/main/docs/GRANT.md
Submit walkthrough	https://github.com/001453/newtranslate/blob/main/docs/GRANT_APPLY.md
Demo site	https://001453.github.io/newtranslate/
Benchmarks	https://github.com/001453/newtranslate/blob/main/docs/BENCHMARKS.md
QVAC	https://qvac.tether.io/
Keet	https://keet.io/

Team & contact

Field	Value
Applicant name	Nihat Cetinkaya
Email	nihatcetinkaya077@gmail.com
GitHub	https://github.com/001453
Location	Turkey

Demo video

Public demo: [YouTube](#) · [docs/DEMO.md](#)

One-line pitch

GlobalBridge AI is an open-source, **sovereign** real-time translation and live-caption stack that combines **Tether QVAC** (on-device AI) with **Keet** (P2P encrypted calls) so multilingual communication never requires sending voice or transcripts to the cloud.

Problem

1. **Privacy** — Enterprises, journalists, and activists cannot send meeting audio to Google/Microsoft cloud STT.
2. **Access** — P2P tools like **Keet** have no built-in multilingual subtitles.
3. **Latency & cost** — Cloud translation adds 1–3 s delay and recurring API fees per caption line.
4. **Sovereignty** — Regulated users need auditable proof that inference stays on-device.

Most AI still runs on remote servers (data leaves the device, latency, exposure). Tether’s **QVAC** and **Pears/Keet** stack offers the opposite: local inference and serverless communication. GlobalBridge connects them into one usable product.

Solution (already built — open source MVP)

Layer	Technology	Where it runs
Speech-to-text	Faster-Whisper	User machine
Translation & summary	QVAC @qvac/sdk	localhost:8765
P2P call	Keet (Holepunch)	Peer-to-peer, E2E
UI	Next.js + WebSocket	localhost:3000
Meeting export	TXT / JSON / SRT	Auto-download on session end

Sovereign Mode (LOCAL_PROCESSING_ONLY=true): no third-party egress for audio, transcripts, or documents.

Architecture

Tab audio / Microphone (Chrome)

→ WebSocket /api/v1/ws/live (localhost)

→ Faster-Whisper STT

→ QVAC bridge (@qvac/sdk) – Bergamot NMT + local LLM

→ Live subtitles + transcript export

Keet flow: User opens Keet call → GlobalBridge /meeting shares Keet tab audio → each viewer sees captions in **their** language via viewer_lang.

QVAC integration (Tether)

- Sidecar: qvac-service/server.js using @qvac/sdk
- Backend client: backend/services/qvac_client.py

- Uses QVAC for **live translation**, **meeting summaries**, and **document/PDF** tasks
- Cloud APIs (Together AI) are **optional** and disabled in Sovereign Mode

Alignment with Tether grants program: Local-first AI, no cloud dependency, open modular stack — exactly what the [May 2026 grants announcement](#) describes for QVAC.

Keet / Pears integration (Holepunch)

- `/meeting` route with Keet invite links (`keet://`)
- Personalized bilingual subtitles without a central media server
- Grant phase will add **Pear SDK research**, deeper hooks, and published integration guide

What grant funding delivers (milestones)

ID	Deliverable	Deadline	Payout
M1	Public demo & docs — 5–8 min video on DEMO.md ; egress checklist ; English setup guide (README)	+30 days	1,500 USD ₹
M2	QVAC hardening — Fix/unify QVAC STT path; benchmark latency (STT + NMT); publish results in docs/BENCHMARKS.md	+60 days	2,000 USD ₹
M3	Pear / Keet integration v2 — Pear SDK spike; improved meeting bridge; integration doc for Pears builders	+75 days	2,000 USD ₹
M4	Chrome extension MVP — Live captions overlay for tab audio (QVAC translation); publish on repo <code>extension/</code>	+90 days	2,000 USD ₹
	Total	~90 days	7,500 USD ₹

M1 partially satisfied by existing repo + README; M1 payout on delivery of demo video + docs per Tether review.

Success metrics

Metric	Target	
Live caption end-to-end latency	≤ 2 s (documented)	BENCHMARKS.md — ~1.9 s p50 ✓
STT languages (Whisper)	99+	
Translation via QVAC	100+ language pairs (Bergamot packs)	
Data egress in Sovereign Mode	Zero (documented)	
Keet meeting transcript export	TXT + JSON + SRT on session end	

Why not a pre-defined bounty?

[tether.dev bounties](#) list WDK wallet tasks and ANE/CoreML QVAC tasks. GlobalBridge is an **application layer** combining **QVAC + Pears/Keet** for accessibility — a fit for “**Applications on Tether’s open tech stack**”, not WDK modules.

Roadmap after grant

1. Electron system-wide overlay
 2. VAD-based speech segmentation (cleaner long-form captions)
 3. Mobile LAN subtitle receiver
 4. Optional WDK integration for paid translation sessions (future)
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Budget justification

Tether’s program pays **\$1,500–\$10,000** per defined task. At **\$7,500** over four milestones, funding covers:

- Engineering (~120–150 h integration + extension work)
 - Documentation and demo production for ecosystem onboarding
 - No ongoing hosting costs — product is fully local/self-hosted
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Checklist before you click Apply

- ☒ Team contact filled in above
 - ☒ Publish demo video → [YouTube](#)
 - ☒ [SOVEREIGN EGRESS CHECKLIST.md](#) published
 - ☒ English setup guide ([README](#))
 - ☒ Latency benchmarks → [BENCHMARKS.md](#)
 - ☒ Step-by-step submit guide → [GRANT APPLY.md](#)
 - ☐ Open <https://tether.dev> → **Apply for a grant** (not a fixed bounty)
 - ☐ Follow [GRANT APPLY.md](#) — paste title, descriptions, links
 - ☐ Payment: **USD₯** · Amount: **7,500 USD₯** (milestone-based)
 - ☐ Save confirmation email / reference ID
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References

- Tether grants announcement: <https://tether.io/news/tether-launches-developer-grants-program-to-fund-local-first-ai-and-payments-infrastructure/>
- Apply / bounties: <https://tether.dev>
- QVAC: <https://qvac.tether.io/>
- Keet: <https://keet.io/>